11.2 Insect Life Cycles

4th Grade Science · Video: Life Cycle of a Butterfly (Learn Bright)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Watch the video and fill in the blanks as you go.

Meet the Butterfly

A butterfly is an insect with four wings that are often bright and colorful.

Tiny _____ on their wings make up their patterns and designs.

Butterflies are _____. Their bodies are the same temperature as the air around them.

Some butterflies hibernate in holes in trees during the winter months.

Stage 1 and Stage 2: Egg and Larva

The adult female butterfly lays from one to hundreds of _____.

The eggs are covered in a _____, glue-like liquid that helps them attach to leaves.

It takes 3 to 6 days for a _____ to develop inside the egg and hatch.

When the caterpillar hatches, it is in the _____ stage, the second stage of its life.

The caterpillar eats leaves and grows for about two weeks or more. It is not an adult yet.

As it grows bigger, the caterpillar sheds its _____ because it gets too big for it.

Stage 3: Pupa

Stage three is called the _____ stage.

The caterpillar attaches itself to a branch or leaf using a bit of _____.

It sheds its skin one last time. Underneath is a hard skin called a _____.

A chrysalis and a _____ are not the same. A cocoon is spun by a moth and made from silk.

Inside, the caterpillar's cells turn into butterfly cells. This is called _____.

Stage 4: Adult

When the butterfly comes out of the chrysalis, the fourth and final stage begins: the _____.

At first it hangs upside down until its wings take shape and become _____.

The adult's job is to _____, or lay eggs, so a new life cycle can begin.

Amazing Butterfly Facts

A butterfly is an insect, so it has _____ legs, two antennae, a head, a thorax, and an abdomen.

Adult butterflies have a long, tube-like tongue called a _____. It works like a straw.

Butterflies taste using their _____!

Butterflies help _____ flowers as they fly from plant to plant.

When it turns cold, _____ butterflies travel to warm places like Mexico or California.

Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
larva	the second stage; for a butterfly, the caterpillar
pupa	the third stage, when the caterpillar changes inside a chrysalis
chrysalis	the hard covering of a butterfly pupa
metamorphosis	the big change from caterpillar to butterfly
proboscis	a butterfly's long, straw-like tongue

Key Takeaways

• A butterfly's life cycle has four stages: egg, larva, pupa, and adult.

• Adult butterflies lay eggs, so the life cycle starts again.